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Volcanic eruptions

For 250,000 years, gigantic volcanoes erupted in India, spewing ash and lava. However, this alone was not enough to cause the extinction of the dinosaurs.



Winners and losers

During the Cretaceous period, some groups of dinosaurs were extremely successful, such as plant-eating, beaked ceratopsians and duck-billed hadrosaurs. Other species declined, including stegosaurus and the long-necked sauropods.



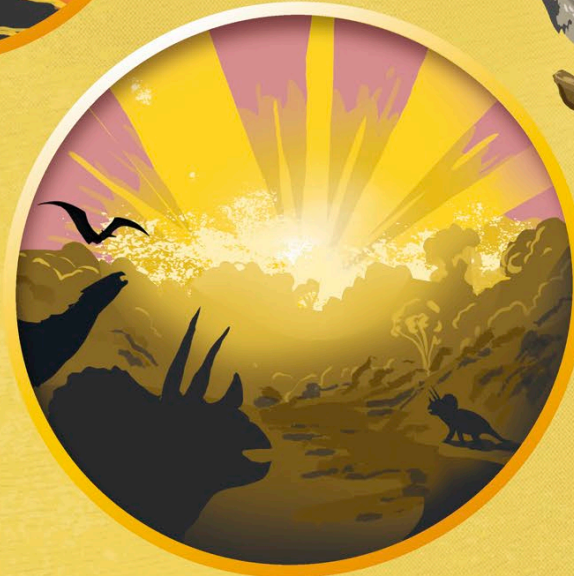
Triceratops—a ceratopsian—was one of the last dinosaurs. It lived alongside T. rex.

Modern dinosaurs

All the birds alive today evolved from small dinosaurs who survived the mass extinction. They are the descendants of feathered meat eaters that walked on two legs and used their forelimbs as wings to fly, more than 150 million years ago. So dinosaurs are still with us, after all!



Take a look outside, and you might see a dinosaur!



Mass extinction

An asteroid 4.3 miles (7 km) wide crashed into the Earth near Chicxulub, Mexico. After the devastation of the initial impact, the dust thrown up made the world cold, dark, and inhospitable. The dinosaurs went extinct—or did they?